

- 8 The photograph shows a Tristan albatross.



(Source: © blickwinkel/Alamy Stock Photo)

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The Tristan albatross is endemic to a few small islands in the South Atlantic Ocean.

The adult birds nest on these islands and fly long distances in search of food.
They feed on fish, octopus and squid.

The Tristan albatross is critically endangered, with 4 500 of these birds left in the wild.

- (a) (i) Describe **two** anatomical adaptations of the Tristan albatross that enable it to occupy its niche.

Use the information in the photograph to support your answer.

(2)

1

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2

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- (ii) It has been predicted that the population will continue to decline by 5.3% per year.

Calculate the predicted albatross population after one year.

(2)

Answer

- (b) The Tristan albatross (*Diomedea dabbenena*) was once classified as the same species as the wandering albatross (*Diomedea exulans*).

The photograph shows a wandering albatross.



(Source: © Rebecca Jackrel/Alamy Stock Photo)

Suggest why the Tristan albatross and wandering albatross were once classified as the same species.

(1)

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- (c) Tristan albatross chicks in nests on one island have been found to be at risk of predation from mice.

The diagram shows an albatross chick and two mice on this island.



Over a long period of time, mice on this island have become 50% larger than normal mice.

It has been suggested that the mice from this island are a new species.

Suggest how the mice on this island have evolved to become a new species.

(4)



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*(d) Scientists have suggested that the Tristan albatross could be conserved.

Some suggestions are conservation strategies on the island where the mice are found.

Some suggestions involve zoos in other countries.

Explain how the Tristan albatross could be conserved.

Use the information in Question 8 to support your answer.

(6)

(Total for Question 8 = 15 marks)

TOTAL FOR PAPER = 80 MARKS

